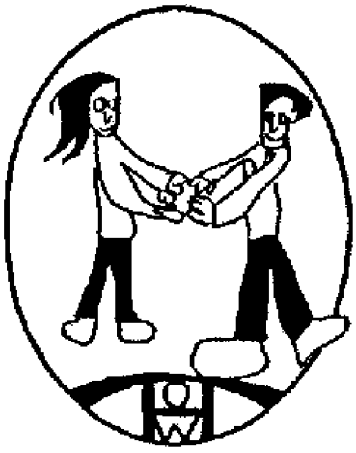
Howbridge Infant School



Early Years Foundation Stage Reception Policy

September 2025

1. Aims

This policy aims to ensure:

- That children access a holistic, broad and balanced curriculum that gives them the broad range of knowledge and skills needed for good progress through school and life
- Quality and consistency in teaching and learning so that every child makes good progress and no child gets left behind
- Close partnership working between teachers, teaching assistants and with parents and/or carers
- Every child is included and supported through equality of opportunity and anti-discriminatory practice

2. Legislation

This policy is based on requirements set out in the Statutory Framework for the early years foundation stage

3. Curriculum

Our Reception children follow the curriculum as outlined in the 'Statutory Framework for the early years foundation stage'. The EYFS framework includes 7 areas of learning and development that are equally important and inter-connected. However, 3 areas known as the prime areas are seen as particularly important for igniting curiosity and enthusiasm for learning, and for building children's capacity to learn, form relationships and thrive.

The **prime** areas are:

- Communication and language
- Physical development
- Personal, social and emotional development

The prime areas are strengthened and applied through 4 **specific** areas:

- Literacy
- Mathematics
- Understanding the world
- Expressive arts and design

3.1 Planning

We follow Early Years Foundation Stage Development Matters and Little Wandle Revised for our planning. We use the schemes White Rose Maths, Get Set 4PE, Kapow for Music and Essex Agreed Syllabus 2022 (Saffron Academy Trust RE Scheme) like the rest of the school as part of our PE, Music and RE learning.

Our planning is topic based with rhymes, stories and real life events being a thread throughout. We build on children's own experiences but endeavour to give them brand new ones as well. Our curriculum is rich in vocabulary. We encourage the children to be curious as explorers, creators and learners. Our learning environment is vibrant and engaging, and the outdoor classroom gives the children opportunities to learn in the natural world. Teachers take into account the individual needs, interests, and stage of development of each child, and use this information to plan challenging and enjoyable experiences. In planning and guiding children's activities, teachers reflect on the different ways that children learn and include these in their practice.

3.2 Teaching
Each area of learning and development is implemented through planned, purposeful play, and through a mix of adult-led and child-initiated activities. Teachers respond to the needs of every child, and provide a range of interesting, engaging and fun tasks and activities.
Throughout the year and as the children's development allows, the balance gradually shifts towards more adult-led activities to help children prepare for more formal learning, ready for year 1.

4. Assessment
Assessment plays an important part in helping parents, carers and teachers to recognise children's progress, understand their needs, and to plan activities and support. At Howbridge Infant School, ongoing assessment is an integral part of the learning and development processes. Staff observe pupils to identify their level of achievement, interests and learning styles. These observations are recorded and shared on Tapestry and in our class floorbooks. These observations are used to shape our future planning. Teachers also take into account observations shared by parents and/or carers in the children's individual Tapestry journal. The Tapestry journals, floor books and the knowledge of the teaching staff, with parental contributions, gives a view of the whole child and is used to assess whether the child is working at the expected level or towards it.

In the final term of the year in which the child reaches age five, and no later than 30th June in that term, the EYFS Profile must be completed for each child. The Profile provides parents, carers, and teachers with a well-rounded picture of a child's knowledge, understanding and abilities, their attainment against expected levels, and their readiness for year 1. The Profile must reflect the teachers' own knowledge and professional judgement of a child to inform discussions with parents and carers, and any other adults whom the teacher, parent or carer judges can offer a useful contribution.

Each child's level of development must be assessed against the early learning goals. Teachers must indicate whether children are meeting expected levels of development, or if they are not yet reaching expected levels ('emerging'). This is the EYFS Profile. The profile reflects ongoing observations and discussions with parents and/or carers. The results of the profile are then shared with parents and/or carers.

5. Working with parents
We recognise that children learn and develop well when there is a strong partnership between teachers, teaching assistants and parents and/or carers. Parents and/or carers are kept up to date with their child's progress and development through the online learning journey - Tapestry. Parents also have termly consultations with the teachers and at the end of the school year they receive a comprehensive report. At Howbridge Infant School we also share 'hints and tips' on our weekly year group newsletters and through memo's and activities posted on Tapestry and School Jotter to give parents ideas and support of how they can support their child at home.

6. Safeguarding and welfare procedures
Our safeguarding and welfare procedures are outlined in our safeguarding policy.

7. Monitoring arrangements
This policy will be reviewed by the EYFS Reception Team in September 2026.